

Section A: Extract Based Comprehension (3 x 5 = 15 marks)

Passage 1

"A thing of beauty is a joy forever: Its loveliness increases; it will never Pass into nothingness; but still will keep A bower quiet for us, and a sleep Full of sweet dreams, and health, and quiet breathing."

Questions & Answers:

1. **MCQ:** What does the poet mean by "A thing of beauty is a joy forever"?
 - A) Beautiful things bring temporary happiness
 - B) Beauty provides eternal joy and comfort
 - C) Beauty fades with time
 - D) Beauty is only appreciated by some
 - **Correct Answer:** B) Beauty provides eternal joy and comfort
2. **MCQ:** What does the phrase "bower quiet" symbolize?
 - A) A place of rest and peace
 - B) A place of chaos and noise
 - C) A place of physical beauty
 - D) A place of loneliness
 - **Correct Answer:** A) A place of rest and peace
3. **Assertion (A):** The poet believes that beauty has a lasting impact on human life.
Reason (R): Beauty provides solace, peace, and inspiration, which remain with us forever.
 - A) Both A and R are true, and R explains A
 - B) Both A and R are true, but R does not explain A
 - C) A is true, but R is false
 - D) A is false, but R is true
 - **Correct Answer:** A) Both A and R are true, and R explains A
4. **Assertion (A):** The poet suggests that beauty can never fade or diminish. **Reason (R):** Beauty is eternal and continues to grow in its impact over time.
 - A) Both A and R are true, and R explains A
 - B) Both A and R are true, but R does not explain A
 - C) A is true, but R is false
 - D) A is false, but R is true
 - **Correct Answer:** A) Both A and R are true, and R explains A
5. **Literary Device:** Identify the literary device used in "A thing of beauty is a joy forever."
 - A) Simile

- B) Metaphor
- C) Alliteration
- D) Personification
- **Correct Answer:** B) Metaphor

Passage 2

"Therefore, on every morrow, are we wreathing A flowery band to bind us to the earth, Spite of despondence, of the inhuman dearth Of noble natures, of the gloomy days, Of all the unhealthy and o'er-darkened ways Made for our searching."

Questions & Answers:

1. **MCQ:** What does "wreathing a flowery band" signify?
 - A) Creating a bond of beauty and positivity with life
 - B) Decorating the earth with flowers
 - C) Binding people to sadness
 - D) Celebrating material wealth
 - **Correct Answer:** A) Creating a bond of beauty and positivity with life
2. **MCQ:** What does the poet mean by "inhuman dearth of noble natures"?
 - A) Lack of material wealth
 - B) Absence of kindness and goodness in people
 - C) Scarcity of natural beauty
 - D) Lack of human population
 - **Correct Answer:** B) Absence of kindness and goodness in people
3. **Assertion (A):** The poet believes that beauty helps us overcome despair and negativity. **Reason (R):** Beauty creates a connection with life, even in the face of challenges and hardships.
 - A) Both A and R are true, and R explains A
 - B) Both A and R are true, but R does not explain A
 - C) A is true, but R is false
 - D) A is false, but R is true
 - **Correct Answer:** A) Both A and R are true, and R explains A
4. **Assertion (A):** The poet suggests that life is full of challenges and darkness. **Reason (R):** Beauty provides a way to escape from the harsh realities of life.
 - A) Both A and R are true, and R explains A
 - B) Both A and R are true, but R does not explain A
 - C) A is true, but R is false
 - D) A is false, but R is true
 - **Correct Answer:** A) Both A and R are true, and R explains A
5. **Literary Device:** Identify the literary device used in "A flowery band to bind us to the earth."
 - A) Imagery
 - B) Metaphor
 - C) Alliteration
 - D) Hyperbole

- **Correct Answer:** B) Metaphor

Passage 3

"Some shape of beauty moves away the pall From our dark spirits. Such the sun, the moon, Trees old, and young, sprouting a shady boon For simple sheep; and such are daffodils With the green world they live in; and clear rills That for themselves a cooling covert make 'Gainst the hot season."

Questions & Answers:

1. **MCQ:** What does the poet mean by "moves away the pall from our dark spirits"?
 - A) Beauty removes sadness and gloom from our lives
 - B) Beauty creates more challenges in life
 - C) Beauty increases the darkness in our spirits
 - D) Beauty makes us forget our responsibilities
 - **Correct Answer:** A) Beauty removes sadness and gloom from our lives
2. **MCQ:** What examples of beauty does the poet mention in this passage?
 - A) The sun, the moon, trees, daffodils, and rills
 - B) The stars, the sky, and the ocean
 - C) Mountains, rivers, and deserts
 - D) Animals, birds, and flowers
 - **Correct Answer:** A) The sun, the moon, trees, daffodils, and rills
3. **Assertion (A):** The poet believes that natural beauty has the power to uplift human spirits. **Reason (R):** Elements of nature like the sun, moon, and trees provide comfort and joy to people.
 - A) Both A and R are true, and R explains A
 - B) Both A and R are true, but R does not explain A
 - C) A is true, but R is false
 - D) A is false, but R is true
 - **Correct Answer:** A) Both A and R are true, and R explains A
4. **Assertion (A):** The poet suggests that beauty is found only in nature. **Reason (R):** The poet lists natural elements like trees and daffodils as examples of beauty.
 - A) Both A and R are true, and R explains A
 - B) Both A and R are true, but R does not explain A
 - C) A is true, but R is false
 - D) A is false, but R is true
 - **Correct Answer:** C) A is true, but R is false
5. **Literary Device:** Identify the literary device used in "Sprouting a shady boon for simple sheep."
 - A) Alliteration
 - B) Personification
 - C) Imagery
 - D) Simile
 - **Correct Answer:** C) Imagery

Section B: Short Answer Questions (12 x 2 = 24 marks)

Story-Based Questions (3)

1. **Why does the poet say that "A thing of beauty is a joy forever"?**
 - Beauty provides **eternal happiness** and never fades from human memory. It continues to grow in significance over time, offering peace and comfort even in distress. The poet believes that moments of beauty leave a lasting impact, sustaining human spirits.
2. **How does beauty help overcome despondency?**
 - The poet suggests that life's struggles—gloom, cruelty, and hardships—can be **softened** by beauty. Natural elements like the sun, trees, and rivers uplift the human spirit, allowing people to experience hope and joy despite life's difficulties.
3. **What examples of beauty does the poet mention?**
 - The poet refers to **nature's wonders**—the sun, the moon, old trees, daffodils, and streams. These symbols of beauty provide calmness, renewal, and relief from life's challenges, proving that nature is an endless source of inspiration.

Value-Based Questions (3)

4. **What moral lesson does the poem convey?**
 - The poem highlights the **importance of appreciating beauty** in life. It teaches that beauty nurtures hope, provides solace, and keeps human emotions positive. The poet urges people to cherish nature and art, as they elevate the soul.
5. **How does beauty create a bond between nature and humanity?**
 - The poet suggests that humans and nature are connected through **beauty and serenity**. Natural elements inspire peace and wisdom, acting as a bridge between the physical and spiritual world, reminding people of life's deeper meaning.
6. **Why does the poet refer to "inhuman dearth of noble natures"?**
 - He expresses **disappointment** in human cruelty and moral decline. However, beauty compensates for this lack, making life meaningful. The poem reinforces that despite negativity, beauty sustains hope.

Competency-Based Questions (4)

7. **What does the phrase "wreathing a flowery band to bind us to the earth" signify?**
 - It symbolizes **human connection** with nature through beauty. The poet believes that experiencing beauty strengthens one's bond with life, offering emotional healing and spiritual fulfillment.
8. **How does beauty contrast with life's dark experiences?**
 - Life is full of **challenges**, yet beauty offers an escape, giving individuals hope, joy, and peace. Natural beauty acts as a refuge from sorrow, reminding people that life has moments worth cherishing.
9. **What role does nature play in uplifting the human soul?**

- Nature provides **comfort** through its calming presence. Elements like shade-giving trees, streams, and flowers renew the spirit, bringing relief from hardships. The poet emphasizes nature's ability to heal emotional distress.

10. How does beauty contribute to spiritual well-being?

- Beauty fosters **inner harmony**, allowing individuals to connect with deeper emotions. It acts as a source of inspiration and enlightenment, proving that moments of beauty enrich the soul beyond material experiences.

Literary Device-Based Questions (2)

11. How does the poet use imagery in the poem?

- The poet creates **vivid pictures** of the sun, trees, and daffodils, enhancing the emotional impact of beauty. His use of rich descriptions makes beauty feel tangible, allowing readers to experience its uplifting effect.

12. Identify and explain the metaphor in "A thing of beauty is a joy forever."

- The phrase compares beauty to **eternal joy**, illustrating that its effect never diminishes. The poet suggests that beautiful experiences remain in memory, providing lifelong comfort and happiness.

Section C: Long Answer Questions (Content is given with sub titles for students' understanding only. It's not compulsory to use them.)

1. Theme-Based Question

How does *A Thing of Beauty* explore the theme of beauty as a source of eternal joy?

Answer:

Introduction: John Keats emphasizes that beauty is timeless and provides everlasting joy. He suggests that no matter how difficult life becomes, beauty remains a source of comfort and inspiration.

Content - Para 1: The poem highlights how beauty uplifts the human spirit, offering peace and relief from suffering. Natural elements like trees, streams, and flowers contribute to this serenity, proving that beauty nurtures the soul.

Content - Para 2: Keats portrays beauty as unchanging, unlike material happiness that fades. Its presence strengthens the mind, easing sorrow and restoring faith in life. He connects beauty with emotions, making it an eternal refuge.

Conclusion: Beauty serves as a powerful force against despair, reminding people that joy is accessible through appreciation of nature and artistic wonders.

2. Value-Based Question

What moral values does *A Thing of Beauty* promote?

Answer:

Introduction: Keats highlights values like **hope, appreciation, and resilience** in the poem. He suggests that beauty enriches life by providing joy and emotional support.

Content - Para 1: The poem teaches **gratitude for nature's gifts**, encouraging people to find happiness in small yet profound moments. Beauty fosters positivity, making life meaningful even during struggles.

Content - Para 2: Keats also reinforces **perseverance**—no matter how dark life feels, beauty restores faith. His philosophy encourages embracing optimism rather than succumbing to despair.

Conclusion: By emphasizing appreciation and endurance, the poem imparts the lesson that beauty is not just physical—it is emotional, spiritual, and transformative.

3. Article-Based Question

Write an article on the significance of nature in *A Thing of Beauty*.

Answer:

Introduction: Nature plays an essential role in Keats' *A Thing of Beauty*, symbolizing peace, renewal, and everlasting joy. His descriptions show how nature heals and rejuvenates the human spirit.

Content - Para 1: Natural beauty acts as an emotional refuge. Trees offer shade, streams provide freshness, and flowers inspire happiness. By illustrating these elements, Keats shows that **nature is the ultimate source of positivity**.

Content - Para 2: Additionally, nature embodies **continuity and harmony**—while human emotions fluctuate, beauty remains. It fosters a connection between people and the universe, proving that joy can always be found in nature.

Conclusion: Keats elevates nature beyond aesthetics, portraying it as essential for emotional and spiritual well-being.

4. Speech-Based Question

Write a speech on the power of beauty to uplift the human soul, referencing *A Thing of Beauty*.

Answer:

Introduction: Respected audience, today I speak on **how beauty uplifts the soul**, as depicted in Keats' *A Thing of Beauty*. Beauty is not just appearance—it is emotional healing.

Content - Para 1: Keats emphasizes that beauty is eternal, giving hope even in dark times. Whether found in nature or art, it provides relief from despair, proving that beauty transforms emotions.

Content - Para 2: He also highlights beauty's **universal appeal**—it comforts people regardless of situation. His philosophy teaches that focusing on beauty fosters happiness and strength.

Conclusion: Beauty, as Keats illustrates, is a force of positivity, inspiring people to persevere and embrace life's wonders.

5. Story-Based Question

How does *A Thing of Beauty* contrast human suffering with the healing power of nature?

Answer:

Introduction: Keats acknowledges human suffering yet presents beauty as a **cure for despair**. He believes that despite hardships, beauty offers renewal and peace.

Content - Para 1: The poem describes life's struggles—gloom, negativity, and sorrow—but contrasts them with **nature's comforting presence**. Streams, trees, and flowers restore the spirit, proving that beauty counteracts difficulties.

Content - Para 2: Keats also highlights that beauty's effect is **continuous**—unlike temporary happiness, nature and art leave lasting joy. His vision suggests that beauty strengthens emotional resilience.

Conclusion: By contrasting pain with beauty, Keats conveys that **hope always exists** when one embraces life's wonders.

6. Author's Point of View-Based Question

How does Keats emphasize the idea of permanence in *A Thing of Beauty*?

Answer:

Introduction: Keats stresses that beauty **never fades**—unlike worldly pleasures, it remains a source of eternal joy and comfort.

Content - Para 1: He uses nature as an example: trees grow, streams flow, and flowers bloom endlessly. These symbols reflect **beauty's enduring presence**, ensuring positivity in life.

Content - Para 2: Keats connects permanence to emotions—beauty is more than appearance, as its impact **deepens with time**. People remember beautiful experiences forever, making beauty a lasting inspiration.

Conclusion: Keats' perspective reinforces the idea that beauty transcends time, proving that its effect is **immeasurable and infinite**.

7. Diary Entry-Based Question

Write a diary entry reflecting on the poem *A Thing of Beauty* and its impact on life.

Answer:

Monday, 9 PM

Dear Diary,

Today, I reflected on *A Thing of Beauty* and realized how deeply it resonates with life. Keats describes beauty as **eternal and transformative**, offering relief during difficult times.

His imagery of **nature's wonders**—trees, rivers, and flowers—reminded me that joy is always present. Beauty is not just visual—it is emotional and spiritual, uplifting the soul.

Keats' belief that beauty never fades has inspired me. Even in sadness, appreciating life's beautiful moments fosters strength and hope.

Until next time,

[Your Name]